

The Mantha Studio — answers

Anirudha Talmale, 1 October 2026. Site: <https://anirudhatalmale6-alt.github.io/manthas-food-palette/>

Hard refresh before you look (Ctrl+Shift+R, or Cmd+Shift+R on Mac).

1. The hero picture

You are right that it is not the latest post, and here is why: I told it to pick her most recent photograph. Almost everything she posts now is a reel, so the newest actual photo is older than the newest post. That was my choice, not a bug, but it clearly surprised you — so pick whichever of these you want and I will set it:

- Her newest photograph — what it does today.
- Her newest post of any kind — this would usually be a reel, so you would get the reel's cover frame as a still. Always current, but you do not get to vet what lands there.
- A pinned post that never changes until you change it — e.g. the acrylic Hanuman you linked.

Can it be the video itself? Technically yes for about half of them, but I would advise against it. Instagram refuses to give me the video file for 121 of her 220 reels, so a video hero would work for some posts and silently fall back to a still for others. It is also a heavy download on a phone. A still picture is the sturdier choice.

Is it hard to manage, and can you change it yourselves later? No, and yes. It is one line in one file, edited in the browser on github.com, and I have written it up for you (see point 6).

2. The two blurbs

Both now use your words exactly:

- Food — "Where every meal tells a story, and every spice brings India to the table."
- Art — "Where colour, texture and tradition come together to tell a story."

One small note, take it or leave it: both lines end on "tells a story". Side by side that repetition is noticeable. If you want, change the Art one to something like "...come together in every piece." Entirely your call — they are your sister's brand, not mine.

3. The commissions line

Added directly under "Made by hand.", in a soft box so it reads as an invitation rather than small print. "Get in touch" is a working link down to the contact section — I clicked it on the live site to be sure it lands in the right place.

4. The peacock feather

I have drawn one and put it beside the initials — see the screenshots. It is drawn in code rather than being a picture file, so it stays razor sharp on any screen and adds nothing to page weight. I gave it the real peacock colours (gold, teal, dark centre, green stem), because a one-colour feather at that size just reads as a dot on a stick — I tried it, it did not work.

If you or Suvarna would rather have a particular feather, send me any image and I will use it instead. No need to hunt for something — mine is there and working, so only replace it if you actively prefer another.

5. The domain, and paying by PayPal

Yes, PayPal is fine, and an Australian account is no problem. Namecheap accepts it — if that has changed by the time you get there, tell me and I will point you at another registrar that does.

The steps:

- Go to namecheap.com and search themanthastudio.com. It was still free when I last checked.
- Buy it in your own name, paying with PayPal. Expect roughly AUD 20 to 25 for the year.
- Decline every extra they offer — hosting, email, SSL, "premium DNS". You need none of it. Do keep WhoisGuard or domain privacy if it is free, which it usually is.
- Since this is a gift and meant to last, consider registering for two or three years at once. It is cheaper per year and removes the risk of it lapsing.
- Then send me a screenshot of the DNS settings page and I will give you the four records to add. The site will be live on the real address within the hour, with HTTPS, at no further cost.

6. Instructions for looking after it

Written and in the repository as MAINTENANCE.md. I have pitched it at exactly your background: someone who can read code but has not done much web work.

It covers changing any text on the page, changing the phone or email, choosing the hero picture, moving a post between Food and Art, forcing the

feed to update immediately, and the two things that can genuinely go wrong (the Instagram token expiring, and a failed sync — neither of which takes the site down).

Everything can be done in a browser on github.com. There is no server, no database and no build step — the whole site is three files plus pictures.

One thing I would suggest, since this is a gift: the repository currently sits under my GitHub account. When you are happy with everything, I can transfer it to an account of yours or Suvarna's, so you own the lot outright and are not dependent on me being around. Say the word and I will do it.

7. Something that proved itself tonight

The automatic sync ran on its own schedule for the first time, with no involvement from me, fetched her 288 posts, re-sorted them and updated the site. That is the part that means neither of you ever has to touch this thing for it to stay current.

Still open

- Which hero option you want (point 1).
- Whether to keep my feather or use one of yours (point 4).
- Both forms still go nowhere — tell me the inbox and I will wire them up.